

History — Unit 1.1–1.5 Key Notes

歷史技巧重點筆記 · Formative MC Quiz — 12 Oct · Hist 6B (Ms Joyce Li)

Built from the actual Unit 1.1–1.5 slides and worksheets in Google Classroom

1.1 Introduction to History 歷史簡介

History = studying the past and how it has changed over time.

歷史 = 研究過去以及過去如何隨時間改變。

Evidence = anything that can be used to prove something. Examples: photographs, letters, fossils.

證據 = 任何可以用來證明某事的東西（照片、信件、化石）。

Primary source 第一手史料 = information coming directly from an eyewitness or participant.

Secondary source 第二手史料 = written later on by someone who did not directly witness.

第一手史料來自親歷者；第二手史料是後人根據第一手資料寫成的。

Reliability 可靠性 = the quality of being trustworthy or of performing consistently well.

Bias 偏見 = prejudice in favour of or against one thing, person, or group compared with another, usually in a way considered to be unfair.

Historical significance 歷史意義 = the worth or importance of a person, event or development from the past.

可靠性 = 值得信賴的程度；偏見 = 不公平地偏袒或針對某人某事。

- Historians ask about evidence: *Who made this? When was it made? Why was it made? Who was it made for?*
- Example sources: Tutankhamun's Mask (pharaoh 1323 BC, tomb found 1922); Terracotta Army (Xi'an, Qin Shi Huang, 221 BC); oracle bones (Shang Dynasty 1600–1046 BC — e.g. "Should the King go to war?").
- Historians value **primary** sources more — they are closest to the event.

1.2 Chronology & Timelines 年代學與時間線

Chronology = the arrangement of events or dates in the order of their occurrence.

Timeline = a line that shows the order of events in history. It includes dates, events, and people. Events go **left → right**.

Century = 100 years · **Decade** = 10 years · **Millennium** = 1,000 years.

BC = Before Christ — every year before the birth of Jesus Christ (Year 1). **BC counts DOWN to 1 BC.**

AD = Anno Domini ("in the year of the Lord") — every year after Year 1. **AD counts UP from AD 1.**

⚠ **There is no year 0.** 1 AD comes immediately after 1 BC.

BC 由大數數到 1 BC ; AD 由 AD 1 數上去 ; 沒有公元 0 年。

Rule 公式	Example 例子
AD century = (year ÷ 100) + 1	AD 476 → 5th century AD · 1903 → 20th century AD · AD 2026 → 21st century AD
BC century = (year ÷ 100) rounded up	551 BC → 6th century BC · 221 BC → 3rd century BC · 320 BC → 4th century BC
20th century	1901–2000

- On a timeline: **BC on the LEFT** (counting down to 1 BC), **AD on the RIGHT** (counting up from AD 1).
- Key events: Confucius born 551 BC · Terracotta Army built ~221 BC · first paper in China AD 105 · Fall of Western Roman Empire AD 476 · first flight 1903.

★ **Quiz trap:** in BC, the BIGGER number is EARLIER (500 BC comes before 300 BC). "Which century comes first: 4th century BC or 10th century BC?" → the 10th century BC!

1.3 Family Trees 家族樹

Family tree = a chart that shows how members of a family are related to each other, using names, dates, and symbols for relationships and generations.

Symbol 符號	Meaning 意思
◻ Square / rectangle	Male ♂ 男性
● Circle / oval	Female ♀ 女性
Horizontal (double) line 橫線	Marriage 婚姻
Vertical line 直線	Parents → children 父母 → 子女

- Family tree key: **b** = birth · **d** = death · **m** = marriage · = shows marriage · vertical line connects parents to children.
- **Generation** = all the people born at about the same time, shown on a different level (Grandparents → Parents → Children).
- Dates matter: they show how old people were, when events happened, and how generations connect.
- Why historians use them: to understand family relationships, see how families change over time, and track inheritance and succession.

1.4 Bias & Reliability 偏見與可靠性

Bias = when a source is one-sided or unfair.

Reliability = how much we can trust a source. It answers: *Is this source telling the truth?*

Primary source 第一手	Secondary source 第二手
Created at the time of the event. Anne Frank's diary · a 1960s photo of HK · oracle bones · the Terracotta Army	Created after the event. Textbooks · articles · documentaries · encyclopaedias · a newspaper article today about the Qin dynasty

★ Ask: **who is more reliable — a witness who was there, or someone who heard about it later?** The witness who was there.

1.5 The 5Ws — Hand of Reliability 五何 · 可靠性之手

Use the 5Ws to judge whether a source is reliable. Each finger of the hand = one W:

W	Questions to ask
Who 誰	Who created the source? Who was present at the event? Who was the audience?

What 什麼	What type of source is it? What is it about? What information is missing?
When 何時	When was it created — during or after the event? Why does the time matter?
Where 何地	Where was it made or found? Why is the location important?
Why 為何	Why was it created — to inform, persuade, entertain or record? Does the creator have a reason to be biased?

Values = what we **CAN** learn from the source (what is useful).

Limitations = what we **CAN'T** learn (what is missing or unreliable).

價值 = 史料能告訴我們什麼；局限 = 史料缺少什麼、不可靠之處。

★ **Quiz-day checklist:** ① Read ALL options before choosing. ② BC: bigger number = earlier. ③ "Primary or secondary?" → check WHEN it was made. ④ Century maths: AD = $\div 100 + 1$, BC = $\div 100$ round up. ⑤ For "why" questions about sources, think: inform / persuade / entertain / record.